

# Creating a z/OS Data Set

Using TSO commands, ISPF panels, and Ansible tasks to create z/OS Data Sets







# DATA SET ALLOCATION AND CATALOGUING

The MVS "room" of the house doesn't use filesystems, inodes, or any other familiar way of managing files. IBM developed their own approach to persisting data before UNIX was invented.

We'll cover that in more detail later, as it is pretty important to know. For now, we'll cover enough to get started using Ansible with z/OS.

Creating a data set (or file) is called *allocating* the data set.

Adding information about the data set to the system catalog is called *cataloguing* the data set.

We can perform these operations interactively through ISPF (or plain TSO) or by writing JCL to run batch jobs that perform them.

With Ansible, we use the `zos_data_set`, `zos_tso_command`, and `zos_job_submit` modules from the `ibm_zos_core` collection to invoke these z/OS operations.



# USING ISPF TO CREATE A DATA SET

```
Menu  Utilities  Compilers  Options  Status  Help
                                           ISPF Primary Option Menu
Option ==> 3

0  Settings      Terminal and user parameters      User ID . : IBMUSER
1  View          Display source data or listings    Time. . . : 11:06
2  Edit          Create or change source data
3  Utilities      Perform utility functions
4  Foreground    Interactive language processing
5  Batch          Submit job for language processing
6  Command       Enter TSO commands
7  Dialog Test   Perform dialog testing
9  IBM Products  IBM program development products
10 SCLM           SW Configuration Library Manager
11 Workplace     ISPF Object/Action Workplace
12 z/OS System   z/OS system programmer applications
13 z/OS User      z/OS user applications

Enter X to Terminate using log/list defaults
```

The ISPF panel for allocating data sets is located under the **Utilities** Option.

We navigate to the Utilities panel by entering its option number (in this case, 3) and pressing Enter.



# USING ISPF TO CREATE A DATA SET

Option 3 from the Primary Option Menu takes us to the Utility Selection Panel.

There are options to manage libraries (PDS and PDSE data sets), basic z/OS data set types (QSAM, etc.), and VSAM data sets. There are also utilities to compare data sets (SuperC and SuperCE) and to search for data sets containing particular values (Search-For and Search-ForE).

The Tables option pertains to customizing the ISPF Editor. It's out of scope for this class. The Udlist option pertains to Unix System Services (USS), also out of scope here.

You can probably surmise from the name of the option and its description that we're looking for **Option 2 – Data Set utilities**.

```
Menu Help
Utility Selection Panel
Option ==> 2
1 Library Compress or print data set. Print index listing. Print,
rename, delete, browse, edit or view members
2 Data Set Allocate, rename, delete, catalog, uncatalog, or display
information of an entire data set
3 Move/Copy Move, or copy members or data sets
4 Dslist Print or display (to process) list of data set names.
Print or display VTOC information
5 Reset Reset statistics for members of ISPF library
6 Hardcopy Initiate hardcopy output
8 Outlist Display, delete, or print held job output
9 Commands Create/change an application command table
11 Format Format definition for formatted data Edit/Browse
12 SuperC Compare data sets (Standard Dialog)
13 SuperCE Compare data sets Extended (Extended Dialog)
14 Search-For Search data sets for strings of data (Standard Dialog)
15 Search-ForE Search data sets for strings of data Extended (Extended Dialog)
16 Tables ISPF Table Utility
17 Udlist Print or display (to process) z/OS UNIX directory list
```

# USING ISPF TO CREATE A DATA SET

```
Menu  Utilities  Compilers  Options  Status  Help
                                           ISPF Primary Option Menu
Option ==> 3.2

0  Settings      Terminal and user parameters
1  View          Display source data or listings
2  Edit          Create or change source data
3  Utilities     Perform utility functions
4  Foreground    Interactive language processing
5  Batch         Submit job for language processing
6  Command       Enter TSO commands
7  Dialog Test   Perform dialog testing
9  IBM Products  IBM program development products
10 SCLM          SW Configuration Library Manager
11 Workplace     ISPF Object/Action Workplace
12 z/OS System   z/OS system programmer applications
13 z/OS User      z/OS user applications

Enter X to Terminate using log/list defaults
```

Pressing PF3 or PF12 takes us back where we came from – in this case, the Primary Option Menu.

We can navigate to nested ISPF panels by entering the Option codes for all the nested levels separated by periods. So, we can reach the Data Set Utilities panel directly from the Primary Option Menu by typing 3.2 and pressing Enter.

The 3 navigates to the Utility Selection Panel and the 2 navigates from there to the Data Set Utilities panel.

# USING ISPF TO CREATE A DATA SET

Here's the upper portion of the Data Set Utility panel. Functions available here include:

**A** – Allocate (create) data set

**C** – Catalog data set

**U** – Uncatalog data set

**D** – Delete (uncatalog and unallocate)

**blank, S** – View detailed or summary information about a data set

**V** – Navigate to the VSAM Utilities panel

When working with z/OS applications, we use these functions frequently.

```
Menu  RefList  Utilities  Help
-----
Option ==> █ Data Set Utility

      A Allocate new data set          C Catalog data set
      R Rename entire data set        U Uncatalog data set
      D Delete entire data set        S Short data set information
blank Data set information           V VSAM Utilities

ISPF Library:
Project . . . _____ Enter "/" to select option
Group  . . . _____ / Confirm Data Set Delete
Type   . . . . _____

Other Partitioned, Sequential or VSAM Data Set:
Name   . . . . . _____
Volume Serial . . . _____ (If not cataloged, required for option "C")

Data Set Password . . . (If password protected)
```

# USING ISPF TO CREATE A DATA SET

```
Menu RefList Utilities Help
Data Set Utility
Option ==> a

A Allocate new data set      C Catalog data set
R Rename entire data set    U Uncatalog data set
D Delete entire data set    S Short data set information
blank Data set information  V VSAM Utilities

ISPF Library:
Project . . . _____ Enter "/" to select option
Group . . . _____ / Confirm Data Set Delete
Type . . . . . _____

Other Partitioned, Sequential or VSAM Data Set:
Name . . . . . qsam1
Volume Serial . . . _____ (If not cataloged, required for option "C")

Data Set Password . . . _____ (If password protected)
```

```
User ID . : IBMUSER
Time. . . : 11:19
Terminal. : 3278
Screen. . : 1
Language. : ENGLISH
Appl ID . : ISR
TSO logon : DB2PROC
TSO prefix: IBMUSER
System ID : VS01
MVS acct. : ACCT001
Release . : ISPF 8.1
```

To identify the data set we want to create, we entered **qsam1** without enclosing the value in apostrophes (single quotes). TSO will change the text to uppercase and prepend the **TSO Prefix** as the HLQ, resulting in data set name **IBMUSER.QSAM1**. We could enter the full data set name within apostrophes: ' **IBMUSER.QSAM1** '.

If we were authorized to create data sets under other HLQs, we could enter the full data set name enclosed within apostrophes, like ' **PROD45.SALES.COMM200** '.



# USING ISPF TO CREATE A DATA SET

```
Menu RefList Utilities Help
Data Set Utility
Option ==> a

A Allocate new data set      C Catalog data set
R Rename entire data set    U Uncatalog data set
D Delete entire data set    S Short data set information
blank Data set information  V VSAM Utilities

ISPF Library:
Project . . . _____
Group . . . _____
Type . . . . . _____

Enter "/" to select option
/ Confirm Data Set Delete

Other Partitioned, Sequential or VSAM Data Set:
Name . . . . . lab.textfile
Volume Serial . . . _____ (If not cataloged, required for option "C")

Data Set Password . . . (If password protected)
```

Project → High-Level Qualifier

Group → Mid-Level Qualifier

Type → Low-Level Qualifier (Name)

A final comment on data set names and ISPF panel fields before we go on. Notice the section of the panel in the middle labeled **ISPF Library**. The **Project** field refers to the High-Level Qualifier. In this example, Project is **MATEVA**, the TSO Prefix. The **Group** field refers to a Mid-Level Qualifier. In this example, the value is **LAB**. The most common convention in z/OS installations is to have one Mid-Level qualifier, although it is valid to have more than one. Providing a single field for Mid-Level Qualifier reflects this convention. The **Type** field is the file name. In this example, the value is **TEXTFILE**. ISPF panels use this terminology consistently. We could enter those values here instead of in the **Other...Data Set** field. ISPF will convert data set name values to uppercase.

# USING ISPF TO CREATE A DATA SET

```
Menu  RefList  Utilities  Help
                                     Data Set Utility
Option ==> a

  A Allocate new data set          C Catalog data set
  R Rename entire data set        U Uncatalog data set
  D Delete entire data set        S Short data set information
blank Data set information        V VSAM Utilities

ISPF Library:
Project . . . _____ Enter "/" to select option
Group . . . _____ / Confirm Data Set Delete
Type . . . . . _____

Other Partitioned Sequential or VSAM Data Set:
Name . . . . . qsam1
Volume Serial . . . _____ (If not cataloged, required for option "C")

Data Set Password . . . _____ (If password protected)
```

We enter the option we want – in this case **A** for **Allocate new data set**, and press Enter.

# USING ISPF TO CREATE A DATA SET

Menu RefList Utilities Help

Allocate New Data Set

Command ==> \_\_\_\_\_

Data Set Name . . . . : **IBMUUSER.QSAM1**

Management class . . . . (Blank for default management class)

Storage class . . . . : SCBASE (Blank for default storage class)

Volume serial . . . . : USRVS1 (Blank for system default)

Multiple Volumes . . . . (Enter '/' to select option)

Device type . . . . : \_\_\_\_\_ (Generic unit or device address)

Data class . . . . : \_\_\_\_\_ (Blank for default data class)

Space units . . . . : TRACK (BLKS, TRKS, CYLS, KB, MB, or RECORDS)

Average record unit . . . . (M, K, or U)

Primary quantity . . . : 2 (In above units)

Secondary quantity . . : 3 (In above units)

Directory blocks . . . : 0 (Zero for sequential data)

Record format . . . . : FBA

Record length . . . . : 80

Block size . . . . : 27920

Data set name type . . . . (LIBRARY, PDS, LARGE, BASIC, \* EXTREQ, EXTPREF or blank)

Data set version . . . : \_\_\_\_\_

Num of generations . . : \_\_\_\_\_

Extended Attributes . . : \_\_\_\_\_

Expiration date . . . : \_\_\_\_\_ (YY/MM/DD, YYYY/MM/DD, YY.DDD, YYYY.DDD in Julian form, DDDD for retention period in days)

F1=Help F2=Split F3=Exit F7=Backward F8=Forward F9=Swap  
F10=Actions F12=Cancel

That takes us to the Allocate New Data Set panel, where we can enter the attributes of the data set we want to create.

The data set name is pre-filled from the previous panel.

Other fields are pre-filled with values from the last time the panel was used. We want to override these values for our new data set.

It's a rule of thumb to take installation defaults for Management class, Storage class, and Data class unless you have a specific reason to use different values.



# USING ISPF TO CREATE A DATA SET

```

Menu  RefList  Utilities  Help

Allocate New Data Set

Command ==>

Data Set Name . . . : IBMUSER.QSAM1

Management class . . . (Blank for default management class)
Storage class . . . SCBASE (Blank for default storage class)
Volume serial . . . USRVS1 (Blank for system default volume) **
Multiple Volumes - (Enter '/' to select option)
Device type . . . (Generic unit or device address) **
Data class . . . (Blank for default data class)
Space units . . . TRACK (BLKS, TRKS, CYLS, KB, MB, BYTES or RECORDS)
Average record unit (M, K, or U)
Primary quantity . . 1 (In above units)
Secondary quantity . 1 (In above units)
Directory blocks . . 0 (Zero for sequential data set) *
Record format . . . FB
Record length . . . 80
Block size . . . 32000
Data set name type (LIBRARY, PDS, LARGE, BASIC, * EXTREQ, EXTPREF or blank)

Data set version . : -
Num of generations : 
Extended Attributes (NO, OPT or blank)
Expiration date . . (YY/MM/DD, YYYY/MM/DD YY.DDD, YYYY.DDD in Julian form DDDD for retention period in days)

F1=Help F2=Split F3=Exit F7=Backward F8=Forward F9=Swap
F10=Actions F12=Cancel

```

DASD space is allocated in *extents*. The primary extent is reserved for the data set when it is allocated. As the data set grows, secondary extents are created to accommodate the additional data.

This example specifies space in terms of tracks, and allocates one track for the primary extent. Secondary extents will consist of 1 track each.

You can also specify the size in terms of cylinders, blocks, records, bytes, kilobytes, or megabytes. The brain in a jar sees everything in terms of IBM 3390 DASD devices, which have tracks and cylinders.

There is an installation-defined limit to how many extents can be added. When an application attempts to exceed this limit, it fails with an abend code of 0B37, 0D37 or 0E37 (these abend codes are equivalent).

# USING ISPF TO CREATE A DATA SET

```
Menu  RefList  Utilities  Help

Allocate New Data Set

Command ==> _____ More: +

Data Set Name . . . : IBMUSER.QSAM1

Management class . . . (Blank for default management class)
Storage class . . . . SCBASE (Blank for default storage class)
Volume serial . . . . USRVS1 (Blank for system default volume) **
Multiple Volumes      - (Enter '/' to select option)
Device type . . . . . (Generic unit or device address) **
Data class . . . . . (Blank for default data class)
Space units . . . . . TRACK (BLKS, TRKS, CYLS, KB, MB, BYTES
                             or RECORDS)
Average record unit   - (M, K, or U)
Primary quantity . . 1 (In above units)
Secondary quantity    1 (In above units)
Directory blocks . . 0 (Zero for sequential data set)
Record format . . . . FB
Record length . . . . 80
Block size . . . . . 32000
Data set name type    _____ (LIBRARY, PDS, LARGE, BASIC, *
                                EXTREQ, EXTPREF or blank)

Data set version . . : -
Num of generations : _____
Extended Attributes  _____ (NO, OPT or blank)
Expiration date . . . (YY/MM/DD, YYYY/MM/DD
                      YY.DDD, YYYY.DDD in Julian form
                      DDDD for retention period in days

F1=Help  F2=Split  F3=Exit  F7=Backward  F8=Forward  F9=Swap
F10=Actions  F12=Cancel
```

**Directory blocks** pertain to libraries – that is, Partitioned Data Sets (PDS, PDSE types). For a "regular" sequential data set, specify zero directory blocks and leave the **Data set name type** field blank.

# USING ISPF TO CREATE A DATA SET

```
Menu  RefList  Utilities  Help

Allocate New Data Set

Command ==> _____ More:  +

Data Set Name . . . : IBMUSER.QSAM1

Management class . . . (Blank for default management class)
Storage class . . . SCBASE (Blank for default storage class)
Volume serial . . . USRVS1 (Blank for system default volume serial)
Multiple Volumes . . . (Enter '/' to select option)
Device type . . . (Generic unit or device address)
Data class . . . (Blank for default data class)
Space units . . . TRACK (BLKS, TRKS, CYLS, KB, MB, GB or RECORDS)

Average record unit . . . (M, K, or U)
Primary quantity . . 1 (In above units)
Secondary quantity . 1 (In above units)
Directory blocks . . 0 (Zero for sequential data sets)

Record format . . . FB
Record length . . . 80
Block size . . . 32000

Data set name type . . (LIBRARY, PDS, LARGE, BASIC, EXTREQ, EXTPREF or blank)

Data set version . . : -
Num of generations . : -
Extended Attributes . (NO, OPT or blank)
Expiration date . . . (YY/MM/DD, YYYY/MM/DD
                      YY.DDD, YYYY.DDD in Julian form
                      DDDD for retention period in days)

F1=Help    F2=Split    F3=Exit    F7=Backward  F8=Forward  F9=Swap
F10=Actions F12=Cancel
```

We're creating a data set with fixed-length records 80 bytes long, grouped into blocks, hence "record format" is "FB".

QSAM reads/writes **blocks** of data, also called *physical records*, and presents the data to application programs one *logical record* at a time. We specify 80 bytes as the logical record length and a block size that is an even multiple of the logical record length.

All this is virtualized today, but when DASD were physical devices the difference in I/O delay could be significant based on these settings.

The remaining fields pertain to other types of data sets or to additional attributes that may be associated with a data set.



# USING ISPF TO CREATE A DATA SET

```
Menu  RefList  Utilities  Help
Data Set Utility  Data set allocated
Option ==> 
A Allocate new data set      C Catalog data set
R Rename entire data set    U Uncatalog data set
D Delete entire data set    S Short data set information
blank Data set information  V VSAM Utilities

ISPF Library:
Project . . . 
Group . . . 
Type . . . 

Enter "/" to select option
/ Confirm Data Set Delete

Other Partitioned, Sequential or VSAM Data Set:
Name . . . . . QSAM1
Volume Serial . . . (If not cataloged, 
Data Set Password . . (If password protect
```

When we press Enter, TSO allocates the data set and returns us to the Data Set Utility panel, where we can work with more data sets if we need to. It displays the result of the allocation request in the upper right-hand corner.

The fields on the ISPF panels correspond to the same attributes we define as parameters on DD statements in JCL or as vars in an Ansible task.

# LAB 5: USING ISPF TO CREATE A QSAM DATA SET

Follow the instructions for Lab 5 in labs/labs.md in the course repo.

# USING IBM\_ZOS\_CORE.ZOS\_DATA\_SET

Now let's see how to do the same thing using the `ibm_zos_core` collection in Ansible.

```
- name: Conditionally delete and then create a sequential data set
hosts: zos
gather_facts: false
collections:
  - ibm.ibm_zos_core
environment: "{{ environment_vars }}"
```

We start with a basic setup, telling Ansible that we want to use `ibm_zos_core` and bringing in the environment.

```
tasks:
  - name: Set facts used in this playbook
    set_fact:
      data_set_name: IBMUSER.QSAM1
```

Now we put the data set name in a var

```
- name: Delete data set if it exists
  zos_data_set:
    name: "{{ data_set_name }}"      # DELETE
    type: sequential                 # Match
    state: absent                    # DELETE
    force: true
    register: result

- name: Display result of data set deletion
  debug:
    msg: "{{ result }}"
```

If the data set already exists, z/OS won't let us create it. (Actually we can override that behavior, but for purposes of example let's handle it manually.)

So, we'll delete the data set if it exists.

Module `zos_data_set` will do this because of the "state: absent" specification.

# USING IBM\_ZOS\_CORE.ZOS\_DATA\_SET

```
- name: Create sequential data set
  zos_data_set:
    name: "{{ data_set_name }}"      # CREATE: DD DSN=(...)
    type: seq                        # CREATE: DD DCB=(DSORG=PS)
    format: fb                       # CREATE: DD DCB=(RECFM=FB)
    record_length: 80                # CREATE: DD DCB=(LRECL=80)
    block_size: 8000                 # CREATE: DD DCB=(BLKSIZE=32000)
    state: present                   # CREATE: DD DISP=(MOD,...)
    replace: true                    # CREATE: DD DISP(...,CATLG,...)
    space_type: trk                  # CREATE: DD SPACE=(TRK,...)
    space_primary: 1                 # CREATE: DD SPACE=(..., (1,...))
    space_secondary: 1               # CREATE: DD SPACE=(..., (...), 1)
  register: result

- name: Display result of data set creation
  debug:
    msg: "{{ result }}"
```

Now we can attempt to create the data set.

The comments to the right of the task show the corresponding values in z/OS Job Control Language (JCL). You've seen the equivalent settings on the ISPF Allocate Data Set panel.

You might notice we're setting the block size to 8000 rather than 32000. That's so we'll be able to tell that our Ansible playbook worked when we look at the data set information in ISPF.



# USING IBM\_ZOS\_CORE.ZOS\_DATA\_SET

Here's the command to run the playbook

```
[ansible@ip-10-0-1-93 mainframe]$ ansible-playbook -i inventory.yml /home/ansible/mainframe/create_qsam.yml
```

```
TASK [Display result of data set deletion] ****
*****
ok: [mainframe] => {
  "msg": {
    "changed": true,
    "failed": false,
    "message": "",
    "names": [
      "IBMUUSER.QSAM1"
    ]
  }
}

TASK [Create sequential data set] *****
*****
changed: [mainframe]

TASK [Display result of data set creation] ****
*****
ok: [mainframe] => {
  "msg": {
    "changed": true,
    "failed": false,
    "message": "",
    "names": [
      "IBMUUSER.QSAM1"
    ]
  }
}

PLAY RECAP *****
*****
mainframe           : ok=5    changed=2
```

This is what we see on the control node after the playbook has run.

"failed: false" means no errors occurred on the Ansible side.

"changed: true" means the task was successful, as far as Ansible can tell.

# USING IBM\_ZOS\_CORE.ZOS\_DATA\_SET

```

                                Data Set Information
Command ==>

Data Set Name . . . . : IBMUSER.QSAM1

General Data                  Current Allocation
Management class . . . : **None**    Allocated tracks . . : 1
Storage class . . . . : SCBASE        Allocated extents . . : 1
Volume serial . . . . : USRVS1
Device type . . . . . : 3390
Data class . . . . . : **None**
Organization . . . . : PS
Record format . . . . : FB
Record length . . . . : 80
Block size . . . . . : 8000
1st extent tracks . . . : 1
Secondary tracks . . . : 1
Data set name type :
Data set encryption : NO

Current Utilization
Used tracks . . . .
Used extents . . . .

Dates
Creation date . . . . : 2026/01/25
Referenced date . . . : ***None***
Expiration date . . . : ***None***

SMS Compressible . . : NO
```

When we return to ISPF and check the attributes of the data set, we see that our block size value of 8000 was applied. We're sure the Ansible playbook worked.

# USING IBM\_ZOS\_CORE.ZOS\_DATA\_SET

```
TASK [Display result of data set creation] ****  
*****  
ok: [mainframe] => {  
  "msg": {  
    "changed": true,  
    "failed": false,  
    "message": "",  
    "names": [  
      "IBMUUSER.QSAM1"  
    ]  
  }  
}
```

Notice that in the results from running the playbook, create\_qsam\_multiple, the "names" item is a list.

This suggests we can operate on multiple data sets in a single task.

Let's explore that.

# USING IBM\_ZOS\_CORE.ZOS\_DATA\_SET

```
---
# This playbook creates multiple QSAM data sets (sequential files)
# on the z/OS instance.

- name: Conditionally delete and create sequential data sets
  hosts: zos
  gather_facts: false
  collections:
    - ibm.ibm_zos_core
  environment: "{{ environment_vars }}"

  tasks:
    - name: Set facts used in this playbook
      set_fact:
        zos_username: IBMUSER

    - name: Create sequential data sets
      zos_data_set:
        name: "{{ item }}"      # CREATE: DD DSN=(...)
        type: seq               # CREATE: DD DCB=(DSORG=PS)
        format: fb              # CREATE: DD DCB=(RECFM=FB)
        record_length: 80       # CREATE: DD DCB=(LRECL=80)
        block_size: 8000        # CREATE: DD DCB=(BLKSIZE=32000)
        state: present          # CREATE: DD DISP=(MOD,...)
        replace: true           # CREATE: DD DISP(...,CATLG,...)
        space_type: trk         # CREATE: DD SPACE=(TRK,...)
        space_primary: 1        # CREATE: DD SPACE=(..., (1,...))
        space_secondary: 1      # CREATE: DD SPACE=(..., (...), 1))

      loop:
        - "{{ zos_username }}.QSAM1"
        - "{{ zos_username }}.QSAM2"
        - "{{ zos_username }}.QSAM3"

      register: result

    - name: Display result of data set creation
      debug:
        msg: "{{ result }}"
```

Here we've modified the create-qsam playbook to create three QSAM data sets with the same attributes.

We do this using the "loop" feature of Ansible.

We also removed the explicit "delete" task because we can specify "replace: true" on the "create" task.



# USING IBM\_ZOS\_CORE.ZOS\_DATA\_SET

```
TASK [Display result of data set creation] *****
ok: [mainframe] => {
  "msg": {
    "changed": true,
    "msg": "All items completed",
    "results": [
      {
        "ansible_loop_var": "item",
        "changed": true,
        "failed": false,
        "invocation": {
          "module_args": {
            "batch": null,
            "block_size": 8000,
            "directory_blocks": null,
            "force": false,
            "format": "fb",
            "key_length": null,
            "key_offset": null,
            "name": "IBMUUSER.QSAM1",
            "record_format": "fb",
            "record_length": 80,
            "replace": true,
            "sms_data_class": null,
            "sms_management_class": null,
            "sms_storage_class": null,
            "space_primary": 1,
            "space_secondary": 1,
            "space_type": "trk",
            "state": "present",
            "tmp_hlq": null,
            "type": "seq",
            "volumes": null
          }
        },
        "item": "IBMUUSER.QSAM1",
        "message": "",
        "names": [
          "IBMUUSER.QSAM1"
        ]
      }
    ]
  }
}
```

The result of running playbook create-qsam-multiple shows the attributes of the data sets that were created. All three data sets have the same attributes.

```
},
"item": "IBMUUSER.QSAM2",
"message": "",
"names": [
  "IBMUUSER.QSAM2"
]
```

```
},
"item": "IBMUUSER.QSAM3",
"message": "",
"names": [
  "IBMUUSER.QSAM3"
]
```

# LAB 6: USING ANSIBLE TO CREATE A QSAM DATA SET

Follow the instructions for Lab 6 in labs/labs.md in the course repo.

# USING IBM\_ZOS\_CORE.ZOS\_DATA\_SET

What if we want to create data sets that have different attributes?

There are many use cases for this when we're provisioning environments for particular uses.

We might need to set up an environment for an application developer who is joining the organization. Let's say her team works with COBOL and REXX, and their application uses DB2.

In that case each developer on the team would need a source library for COBOL, one for REXX, a program object library, and a library for QMF scripts.

These libraries are a different type of z/OS data set known as a PDSE, or Partitioned Data Set Extended.

We'll defer creating these types of datasets until we've learned a little more about how they are implemented and used.

# LAB 7: USING JCL TO CREATE A QSAM DATA SET

Follow the instructions for Lab 7 in labs/labs.md in the course repo.

# LAB 8: SUBMIT JCL FROM ANSIBLE

Follow the instructions for Lab 8 in labs/labs.md in the course repo.



# USING TSO TO CREATE A DATA SET

```
Menu Utilities Compilers Options Status Help
ISPSP Primary Option Menu
Option ==> 6
0 Settings      Terminal and user parameters
1 View          Display source data or listings
2 Edit          Create or change source data
3 Utilities      Perform utility functions
4 Foreground    Interactive language processing
5 Batch         Submit job for language processing
6 Command       Enter TSO commands
7 Dialog Test    Perform dialog testing
9 IBM Products  IBM program development products
10 SCLM          SW Configuration Library Manager
11 Workplace     ISPF Object/Action Workplace
12 z/OS System   z/OS system programmer applications
13 z/OS User     z/OS user applications

Enter X to Terminate using log/list defaults
```

Just as Ansible is an abstraction over z/OS, ISPF is an abstraction over TSO.

You can create a z/OS data set with a TSO command, either from the bare TSO UI or from the ISPF Command Shell panel.

If you're accustomed to working on a \*nix command line, you might find this easier than filling in fields on an ISPF panel. Either way, it's good to understand how to do it.

# USING TSO TO CREATE A DATA SET

```
Menu List Mode Functions Utilities Help
ISP Command Shell
Enter TSO commands below:
===> alloc da(qsam1) dsorg(ps) space(2,0) tracks lrecl(80) blksize(8000) recfm(
f,b) new
Place cursor on choice and press enter to Retrieve command
=>
=>
=>
=>
=>
=>
=>
=>
=>
=>
```

Here's the ISPF Command Shell panel with a TSO ALLOCATE command entered, ready to execute.

**Notice a "gotcha" here:** In this context, you can't type "recfm(fb)". The TSO command parser requires the "f" and "b" to be separated by a comma.

When we submit the same TSO command from an Ansible playbook, you'll see a different "gotcha".

You're in the Land of Gotchas.

# USING TSO TO CREATE A DATA SET

```

                                Data Set Information
Command ==>

Data Set Name . . . . : IBMUSER.QSAM1

General Data                    Current Allocation
Management class . . . : **None**    Allocated tracks . . : 1
Storage class . . . . : SCBASE        Allocated extents . . : 1
Volume serial . . . . : USRVS1
Device type . . . . . : 3390
Data class . . . . . : **None**
Organization . . . . . : PS
Record format . . . . : FB
Record length . . . . : 80
Block size . . . . . : 8000
1st extent tracks . . : 1
Secondary tracks . . . : 1
Data set name type :
Data set encryption : NO

Current Utilization
Used tracks . . . . . : 0
Used extents . . . . : 0

Dates
Creation date . . . . : 2026/01/25
Referenced date . . . : ***None***
Expiration date . . . : ***None***

SMS Compressible . . : NO
```

After running the command, we see the data set was created with the attributes we specified.

# LAB 9: USING TSO TO CREATE A QSAM DATA SET

Follow the instructions for Lab 9 in labs/labs.md in the course repo.

# USING ZOS\_TSO\_COMMAND TO CREATE A DATA SET

```
--
# This playbook uses zos_tso_command to create a QSAM data set
# on the z/OS instance.

- name: Submit a TSO command to create a QSAM data set
  hosts: zos
  gather_facts: false
  collections:
    - ibm.ibm_zos_core
  environment: "{{ environment_vars }}"

  tasks:

    - name: Create a data set using TSO ALLOC
      ibm.ibm_zos_core.zos_tso_command:
        commands:
          - ALLOC DA(QSAM2) NEW CATALOG SPACE(1 1) TRACKS DSORG(PS) RECFM(F) LRECL(80) BLKSIZE(800)
        register: result

    - name: Display result of data set creation
      debug:
        msg: "{{ result }}"
```

Module `zos_tso_command`, part of `ibm_zos_core`, submits TSO commands from Ansible playbooks.

Here we use it to create a QSAM data set.

## Gotchas:

1. The TSO command must be all on one line.
2. RECFM is just F; the presence of BLKSIZE tells the system the data set is blocked.
3. The subparameters of SPACE are separated by a space; commas are not allowed in this context.



# USING ZOS\_TSO\_COMMAND

```
---
# This playbook uses zos_tso_command to obtain the user's TSO
# profile and list the datasets catalogued under that userid.

- name: Get TSO profile and listcat
  hosts: zos
  gather_facts: false
  collections:
    - ibm.ibm_zos_core
  environment: "{{ environment_vars }}"

  tasks:

    - name: Get TSO user profile and listcat
      ibm.ibm_zos_core.zos_tso_command:
        commands:
          - PROFILE
          - PROFILE PREFIX(IBMUSER)
          - LISTCAT LEVEL(IBMUSER)
        register: result

    - name: Display result
      debug:
        msg: "{{ result }}"
```

Module `zos_tso_command` isn't the first choice for creating data sets. For that, we'd normally use module `zos_data_set`.

Let's say you wanted to check the TSO profile of a user, and you wanted to get a list of all the data sets catalogued with that user's z/OS id as the high-level qualifier.

You don't have to log on to the z/OS instance to do that, as you can do it with the `zos_tso_command` module.

Here's a playbook that gets the default TSO profile, the specified user's TSO profile, and LISTCAT output for the specified user.

You need both the default profile and the user's profile because the user's profile will contain only overrides, and not all the settings. It inherits settings from the default profile. This command doesn't merge the two.

When you enter the command directly in TSO, it *does* merge the inherited defaults with the user profile settings.

# USING ZOS\_TSO\_COMMAND

```
TASK [Get TSO user profile and listcat] *****
changed: [mainframe]

TASK [Display result] *****
ok: [mainframe] => {
  "msg": {
    "changed": true,
    "failed": false,
    "max_rc": 0,
    "output": [
      {
        "command": "PROFILE",
        "content": [
          "IKJ56688I CHAR(0) LINE(0)  PROMPT  INTERCOM  NOPAUSE MSGID  NOMODE  NOWTPMSG NORECOVER PREFIX(IBMUSER)  PLANGUAGE(ENU) SLANGUA",
          "GE(ENU) VARSTORAGE(LOW)  ",
          ""
        ],
        "failed": false,
        "lines": 3,
        "rc": 0,
        "stderr": ""
      },
      {
        "command": "PROFILE PREFIX(IBMUSER)",
        "content": [
          ""
        ],
        "failed": false,
        "lines": 1,
        "rc": 0,
        "stderr": ""
      }
    ],
    "rc": 0,
    "stderr": ""
  }
}
```

Here's part of the result returned from running playbook get\_user\_profile\_and\_listcat.

It shows the default profile settings and overrides for user IBMUSER, of which there are none at this time.

# USING ZOS\_TSO\_COMMAND

```
{  
  "command": "LISTCAT LEVEL(IBMUSER)",  
  "content": [  
    "NONVSAM ----- IBMUSER.BUILD.COBO",  
    "      IN-CAT --- CATALOG.VS01.TSO",  
    "NONVSAM ----- IBMUSER.BUILD.OBJ",  
    "      IN-CAT --- CATALOG.VS01.TSO",  
    "NONVSAM ----- IBMUSER.COMMON.CACERT",  
    "      IN-CAT --- CATALOG.VS01.TSO",  
    "NONVSAM ----- IBMUSER.D142.T1019166.IMS15J11",  
    "      IN-CAT --- CATALOG.VS01.TSO",  
    "NONVSAM ----- IBMUSER.EX1.DATA",  
    "      IN-CAT --- CATALOG.VS01.TSO",  
    "NONVSAM ----- IBMUSER.HCD.MSGLOG",
```

Here's part of the result for the LISTCAT command. You get the data set name, the catalog in which it is catalogued, and the type of catalog entry. In this example, all the data sets shown are NONVSAM.

# LAB 10: USING ANSIBLE TO RUN A TSO COMMAND

Follow the instructions for Lab 10 in labs/labs.md in the course repo.

# WHAT YOU KNOW AND WHAT YOU CAN DO

- You can create a QSAM dataset using a TSO command, ISPF panels, or an Ansible playbook.
- You can issue TSO commands from an Ansible playbook.

# WHAT'S NEXT

- z/OS Subsystems and JES